

THE POINT

UPI RISES, CASH STAYS

India's rapid shift to digital payments has not reduced its appetite for cash. Despite the explosive growth of digital transactions and UPI, currency in circulation continues to rise. RBI Deputy Governor Shirish Chandra Murmu has called this a "cash paradox". The simultaneous growth of digital transactions and physical currency has made it harder for the RBI to predict cash demand and plan currency production

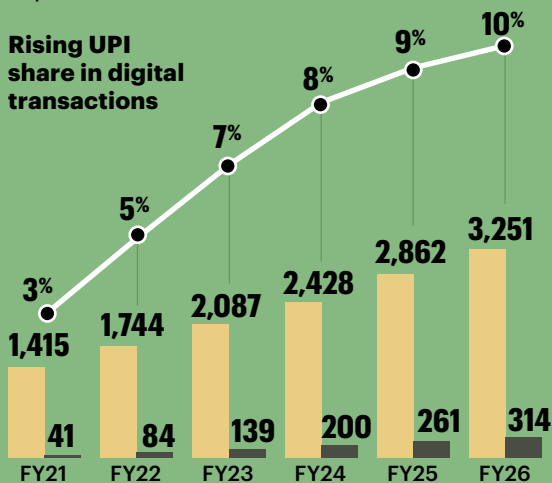
TEXT BY **UJJWAL THAKUR & PRINCE TYAGI**

GRAPHIC BY **TANMOY CHAKRABORTY**

EXPANDING DIGITAL FOOTPRINT

Digital transactions rose from ₹1,415 lakh crore in FY21 to ₹3,251 lakh crore in FY26

Rising UPI share in digital transactions



■ Total Digital Payment (₹ lakh crore)
■ UPI transaction value (₹ lakh crore)
— Share of UPI in digital payments

Note: Total digital payments include credit transfers, retail credit transfers, debit transfers and direct debits, card payments, and prepaid payment instruments

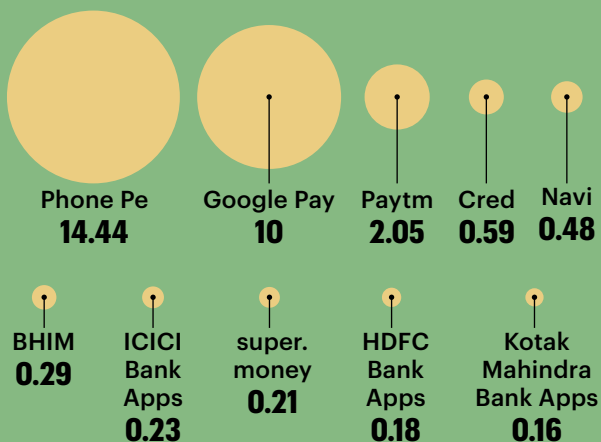
Source: RBI



THE BIG UPI APPS

PhonePe led the market in July 2026 with transactions worth ₹14.44 lakh crore, followed by Google Pay at ₹10 lakh crore

Transaction Value (₹ lakh crore)



Source: NPCI



**70.6
BILLION**

The ₹500 note is the most widely circulated currency denomination in India, accounting for 41% of the total 171 billion banknotes in circulation. The ₹10 and ₹100 notes account for 16% each, followed by ₹20 notes at 8%